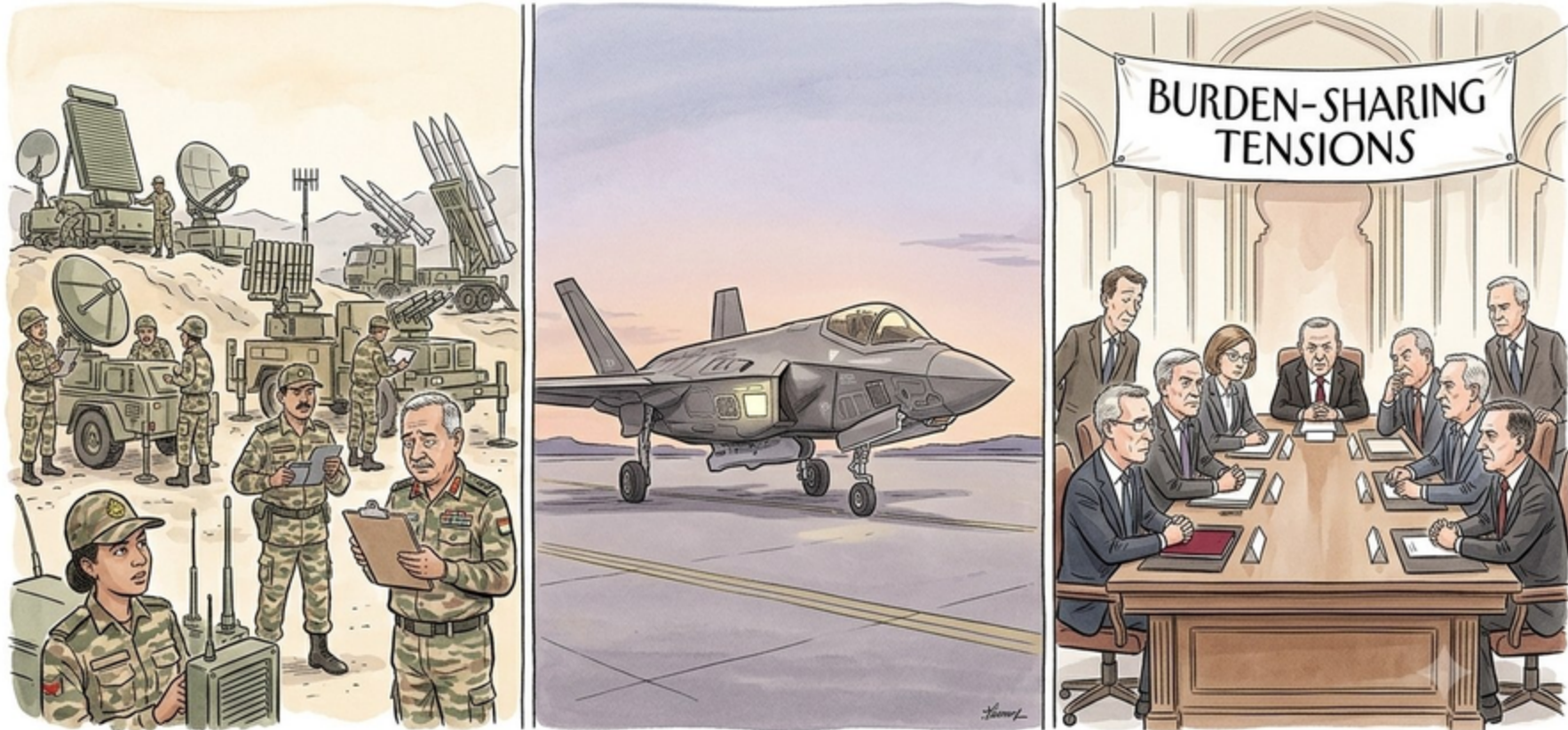


Defense Brief

July 05, 2026



India's ₹52K Crore Arms Push, F-35 Readiness at 25%, NATO Summit Kicks Off in Ankara

The Bottom Line

A convergence of procurement decisions, industrial realignments, and alliance politics is reshaping the defence landscape this week. India's ₹52,000 crore package makes counter-drone and air defence its top acquisition priority. The UK committed £298 billion with heavy drone and GCAP spending. Germany exited FCAS and formed Team Gen 6, fragmenting European fighter development into two competing paths. The F-35 fleet's 25% full mission capable rate casts a shadow over all these programmes — including a potential F-35 sale to Turkey at the Ankara summit. Meanwhile, the US is prepositioning war-ready stocks in Australia while European allies plug the gaps left by American redeployments, a dual-theatre balancing act that the NATO summit will stress-test starting July 7.